TESTER'S GUIDE · ABOUT 30 MINUTES

Test the Dot content machine

Thank you for testing this. You'll set the machine up in your own Claude account, using only the files, and run it once on a real question. The point is to find out whether someone who has never seen it can make it work without help.

What it is. Dot sells an AI data analyst. This "machine" is a set of rules and instructions that Claude follows to decide whether a buyer's question is worth writing an article about, and what Dot would have to test to answer it honestly. You're testing the first stage, called RESEARCH.

One rule: please don't ask me anything while you do it. If you get stuck, try your best, then write down where and why. Those notes are the most useful part of the test.

The whole test, in six steps



About 30 minutes in total. Keep a timer running from step 1.

Names you'll see, and what each one is

Name in this guide	What it is	Where you'll find it
CLAUDE.md	A **file**: the rulebook	Your dot-content-machine folder
Instructions	A **box in Claude**, not a file. You paste CLAUDE.md's text into it	Your Claude Project's page
Files (or Project knowledge)	A **box in Claude** where uploaded files live	Your Claude Project's page
prompts/01-research.md	A **file**: the RESEARCH stage's instructions. You upload it; you don't open it	The prompts folder
RESEARCH	The first stage of the machine. You run it by pasting the template	Step 5
The template	The grey text block you fill in and paste	Step 5 of this guide

What you need

You need	Notes
A Claude account that has Projects	claude.ai. If you don't see "Projects" in the left menu, tell me after the test
A Perplexity account	perplexity.ai. The free plan is fine
A web browser and about 30 minutes	Phone works, but a computer is much easier
Nothing else	No Ahrefs, no Dot account, no coding

STEP 1 · 5 MINUTES

Get the files

Start your timer now

If I invited you on GitHub:

1. Open the invitation email from GitHub and click **Accept invitation**.
2. On the repository page, click the green **Code** button, then **Download ZIP**.
3. Open your Downloads folder and double-click the zip to unzip it.

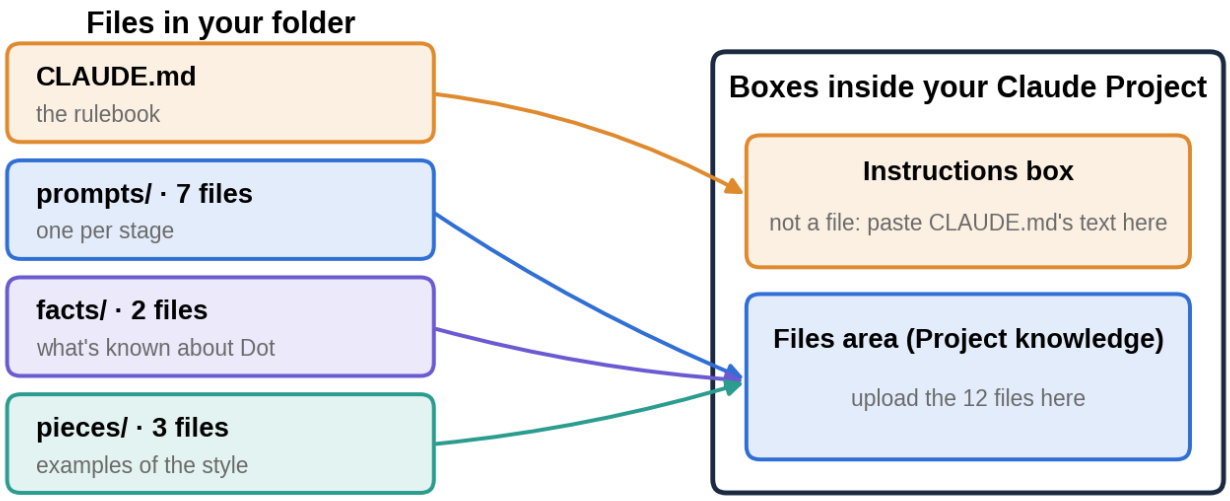
If I sent you a zip instead: download it and double-click to unzip.

Either way, you now have a folder called **dot-content-machine**. Check it contains a file called **CLAUDE.md** and folders called **prompts**, **facts** and **pieces**.

STEP 2 · 10 MINUTES

Set up the Claude Project

CLAUDE.md's text goes into the Instructions box; twelve files go into the Files box



Left: files in your folder. Right: the two boxes inside Claude.

Two kinds of thing, two kinds of name. CLAUDE.md is a **file** in your folder: the rulebook. **Instructions** and **Files** are **boxes inside Claude**, on your Project's page. There is no file called "Instructions": you copy the text of CLAUDE.md and paste it into the Instructions box.

1. Go to **claude.ai**, click **Projects** in the left menu, then **Create project**. Name it **Dot Content Machine**.
2. On the Project's page, find the two boxes: **Instructions** and **Files** (Claude may call the second one **Project knowledge**).
3. In your folder, open the file **CLAUDE.md** in Notepad (Windows: right-click → Open with → Notepad) or TextEdit (Mac). Select everything (**Ctrl + A** or **Cmd + A**) and copy it.

4. Back in Claude, click the **Instructions** box, paste, and save.
5. Click the **+** on the **Files** box, choose **Upload**, and upload these 12 files from your folder:

Folder	Files to upload	How many
prompts	01-research.md, 02-outline.md, 03-draft.md, 04-reader.md, 05-fact-check.md, 06-edit.md, 07-linkedin.md	7
facts	dot-facts.md, house-structure-and-links.md	2
pieces	piece-1.md, piece-2.md, piece-3.md	3

Don’t upload anything else (no scripts, charts or spreadsheets). If you can’t find where to upload, note it down: that’s a useful finding.

STEP 3 · 1 MINUTE

Check it loaded

One question proves the rules are active

1. In the Project, start a **new chat** (the message box on the Project page).
2. Type: **What are the four human decisions?** and send it.

A correct answer names these four: the question, the outline, the title, and publishing. If it gives a general answer about decision-making instead, the CLAUDE.md text didn’t save in the Instructions box. Go back to Step 2, point 4.

Take a screenshot of the answer.

STEP 4 · 5 MINUTES

Collect the inputs

What a buyer finds today when they ask this question

Your question, the same one I tested, so we can compare results:

How do we stop different teams getting different numbers for the same metric?

1. **Perplexity:** go to perplexity.ai, paste the question, and send. When the answer finishes, select the **whole answer** and copy it into a notepad.
2. **Google:** search **different teams different numbers same metric**. Copy the titles of the **first three normal results** (scroll past any AI summary at the top) into the notepad, with each website name.
3. **Ahrefs and Dot:** skip these. You don’t have access, and the template handles it.

STEP 5 · 3 MINUTES

Run RESEARCH

Paste the template, filled in, into a new Project chat

1. Copy the template below into your notepad.
2. Replace the two parts in square brackets with what you collected in Step 4. Leave everything else exactly as it is.
3. Start a **new chat** in the Project, paste the whole thing, and send it.
4. Wait for the full answer. It takes a minute or two.

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Run prompts/01-research.md (from project knowledge) for this question. This is a live
run, so some inputs are partial: say what's missing rather than guessing, and don't use
anything you remember about any page or product.

The question, in the buyer's words: "How do we stop different teams getting different
numbers for the same metric?"

Inputs:
1. Perplexity's answer to the question, pasted in full (today):
[PASTE THE WHOLE PERPLEXITY ANSWER HERE]

2. Top three Google results for "different teams different numbers same metric" (today):
[TITLE 1 (website) · TITLE 2 (website) · TITLE 3 (website)]

3. Ahrefs Keywords Explorer: not pulled for this run.

4. Search Console: not pulled for this run.

Return the five sections as usual, and end with:
- A one-line verdict: PIECE or NOT A PIECE, and why.
- The first three test questions I should ask Dot, in a buyer's words, with what a
  correct answer would need to state.
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STEP 6 · 5 MINUTES

Read the result, record it, and send it

Stop your timer

How to read the verdict



The answer ends with one of these three, plus three test questions.

Send me these

Item	What to send
Your total time	From Step 1 to the end of Step 5

Item	What to send
Screenshot 1	The answer to “What are the four human decisions?”
Screenshot 2	The verdict line and the three test questions
Your notes	Every place you got stuck, confused or unsure, even small ones
The feedback form	The last page of this guide, filled in

A WORKED EXAMPLE

What my run of the same question produced

28 October 2026 · 13 minutes · compare yours with this

Perplexity’s answer. Four sources, all advice: acceldata (3 citations), solv-systems (2), dataplexlabs (2), owox (1). It recommended writing a “metric contract”, one owner per metric, and a one-hour workshop. Dot wasn’t cited, and none of the sources showed a real test.

What RESEARCH did with it. It returned five sections: the gap, the words buyers use, the test to run in Dot, a table of sources, and stop conditions. It also listed what was missing from the inputs instead of guessing.

> **The verdict:** PIECE, conditional on the test covering five metrics. Why the condition: Dot’s piece 1 already showed this problem on one metric, so a new article only adds something if it proves more.

The three test questions it proposed:

Ask Dot	A correct answer must state
“whats our average order value”	The number, the population (delivered orders), that shipping is excluded, and the order count
“finance has 137.75 for average order value and we have 137.04 — which is right”	That both can be correct, the two populations behind them, and which one it used
“whats our revenue including cancelled orders”	Whether it followed the question or its own definition, the number, and the order count

What Dot answered to the first one (you can skip this step; it needs a Dot account):

> *“Our average order value is BRL 137.04 per delivered order across the full uploaded cohort. This is merchandise value only, based on 96,478 delivered orders; all delivered orders had item records and non-null prices.”*

That meets all four conditions RESEARCH set. **Your run won’t match word for word**, and that’s fine: Perplexity answers vary from day to day. What should match is the shape: five sections, a verdict with a reason, and three test questions.

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

Common problems

Try the fix, and note the problem anyway

What happens	Likely cause	Try this
It doesn't know what "prompts/01-research.md" is	The prompt files weren't uploaded to the Files box	Upload the 7 files in prompts/, then start a new chat
It gives a general answer to the four-decisions question	The text didn't save in the Instructions box	Paste CLAUDE.md's text into the Instructions box again, save, start a new chat
It asks you questions instead of answering	It's unsure about an input	Reply: "Use what you have, say what's missing, and continue"
The answer stops halfway	A long answer was cut off	Type "continue"
Your verdict differs from mine	Different Perplexity or Google results	Fine. Send it anyway: differences are useful
No "Projects" in your Claude menu	Your plan may not include Projects	Stop and tell me; that's a finding too

Optional, if you use Claude Code

Open the folder in Claude Code and type: **Run python scripts/check_piece.py pieces/piece-1.md**. It should end with **18 pass, 0 fail, 0 partial, 6 for a human**. Install the two libraries first if asked: **pip install pandas matplotlib**.

FEEDBACK FORM

Please fill this in and send it back

Honest answers help most

Question	Your answer
Total time, Step 1 to Step 5	
Did the four-decisions check give the right answer? (yes / no)	
What was the verdict? (PIECE / PIECE IF / NOT A PIECE, and the reason)	
Did it give three test questions? (yes / no)	
Where did you get stuck or confused? (step number and what happened)	
Which instruction in this guide was unclear?	
How confident would you feel doing it again alone? (1–5)	
Anything else?	

Thank you. Your notes go straight into fixing the guide before the people at Dot use it.